

Jagran New Media: Leveraging data to grow brand love and provide a seamless news experience for readers

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ABOUT Jagran Media



About Jagran Media Network

Jagran Media Network improves brand love and enables a seamless news experience on its platforms with the scalability and flexibility of Google.

Jagran New Media (<https://www.jnm.digital/>) is the digital arm of the Jagran Prakashan Limited, a leading media and communications group with its interests spanning across Print, OOH, Activations, Radio and Digital in India consisting of 10 digital platforms spread across news, lifestyle, education, health, even gaming. The brand operates in Hindi, English, Gujarati, Tamil, and soon, will be launching its Telugu, Marathi language platforms. The company publishes

Google Cloud results

- Improves time spent on the website from 1 minute to 3 minutes
- Releases new applications in just 1 day, instead of 15
- Uses autoscaling to automatically add and remove VM instances in real time to scale quickly
- Stores content and archives on Cloud Storage without provisioning or running a separate backup service

Increase
love to
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Look

multimedia content, which includes over 7,000 stories and 40 videos in a day.

Industries: Media & Entertainment

Location: India

Cloud Run (<https://cloud.google.com/run/>).



About NTT Global Data Centres & Cloud Infrastructure India Private Limited

NTT Global leverages the best of modern IT with Google Cloud managed services, understanding every business' objective before planning and executing a migration to cloud. It is a global Google Cloud partner with deep technical know-how to help customers get the best out of their cloud investments.

(<https://workspace.google.com/>), Kubernetes

Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)

(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>),
BigQuery (<https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/>)

Calendar

(<https://workspace.google.com/products/calendar/>)

- Improved security and protection and continuous compliance assurance

Cloud CDN (<https://cloud.google.com/cdn/>)

Cloud Run (<https://cloud.google.com/run/>) help.

Cloud Storage (<https://cloud.google.com/storage/>)

Cloud SQL (<https://cloud.google.com/sql/>)

Compute Engine
(<https://cloud.google.com/compute/>)

Gmail
(<https://workspace.google.com/products/gmail/>)

Cloud Pub/Sub (<https://cloud.google.com/pubsub/>)

Operations
(<https://cloud.google.com/products/operations>)

Logging (<https://cloud.google.com/logging/>)

Monitoring (<https://cloud.google.com/monitoring/>)

Looker Studio
(<https://cloud.google.com/looker-studio>)

Google Meet
(<https://workspace.google.com/products/meet/>)

Google Drive
(<https://workspace.google.com/products/drive/>)

Google Workspace
(<https://workspace.google.com/>)

Kubernetes Engine
(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>)

Google Cloud Armor
(<https://cloud.google.com/armor/>)

The nature of the news media in moves fast, and is changing all the time. As a key player, organizations need to move fast enough to adopt new technologies. They also need to be accessible and available, particularly when there are emergencies that take place. As a media organization, Jagran New Media (<https://www.jnm.digital/>) (JNM) publishes online news and content to inform and educate, with a mission to make better life decisions. Its digital presence, Jagran New Media has a reach of 100 million users and 67.18 million views on YouTube. In order to maintain a digital platform, the organization needs to modernize its applications so that it can provide a better experience when searching for information.

"A CEO must wear many hats in today's changing digital landscape. Profit is not drive a business. In a rapidly changing world like India, we must be agile, disruptive, and innovative all at the same time. As publishers, it is essential to understand the core value proposition.

We at Jagran New Media take pride in being a content first company.

"I prefer a Build, Buy, and Partner model. This is where Google, as a partner, brings in knowledge, talent, and technology. This is the age of collaboration, and I am delighted that our teams successfully collaborated to study, evolve, and innovate the right tech stack that is critical to scaling operations in a secure yet sustainable manner," says Bharat Gupta, CEO at Jagran New Media.

"Whether it's disseminating academic board results or political news updates, we are the main source of information. This is why we would often see a surge in traffic to our platforms around important events, and need to ensure that we are able to support the load when it happens," says Ravi Kumar, Head of IT Infrastructure at Jagran New Media. With that in mind, Jagran completed a lift and shift migration from Compete Cloud and On-Prem architecture across multiple data centers to Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>) in 2019, with the support of NTT Global Data Centres & Cloud Infrastructure India Private Limited (NTT).

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There were two reasons for the move to cloud. The first was the need to modernize its infrastructure by moving away from monolithic applications and on-prem data centers, to keep up with the current technologies that provided much more leeway to innovate. The second, was to address the immediate

concerns that were quickly becoming less sustainable both on an operational and cost perspective.

"At one point, we started having issues with infrastructure provisioning and scalability. It became a very time-consuming and costly process every time we needed to scale to support a specific event. This is one of the key reasons we decided to migrate our entire infrastructure to Google Cloud," says Ajit Kumar, Associate Vice President of Technology at Jagran New Media. NTT helped Jagran streamline its multiple microservices securely on a shared virtual private cloud (VPC), saving the organization a lot of egress cost.

Prior to Google Cloud, Jagran had actually onboarded to a different cloud provider together with a co-location service by NTT (<https://services.global.ntt/>). However, the positive support from the Google Cloud team made the decision to move to Google Cloud for its end-to-end services an easy one, as queries were answered quickly so that the Jagran team could make informed decisions prior to committing.

Supporting high traffic influx seamlessly and increasing brand love by 300%

During the pandemic, the organization saw a huge traffic spike on its education platform Jagranjosh.com when the government academic board results were released. "We are one of the few government-authorized platforms for releasing the

board results, so many people logged on to our platform when the results were released and we saw a large influx of visitors to our website," explains Ravi Kumar. With Compute Engine (<https://cloud.google.com/compute>) that automatically adds or removes VM instances based on load, Jagranjosh was able to scale up quickly in real time to support the high traffic load, and quickly scale back down again after the peak periods.

"Not only was this a really effective and reliable way to run our platform, the pay-as-you-go structure meant that we only paid for what we needed. This is a far-cry from running the website on-prem as we would have a lot of upfront costs to manage, and many times, we may not end up using everything we pay for, which results in a lot of wastage," says Ravi Kumar, adding that now, the organization can significantly reduce its capital and operating costs because it no longer needs to keep track and implement the largest hardware, enterprise software licensing and renewal, or any hardware support fees.

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The organization's news website also saw an increase in page views by 50% month on month since the migration, where the average user is now spending two to three minutes on a page, from just one minute previously. "Using Looker Studio (<https://cloud.google.com/looker-studio>), we can better understand what content works and what doesn't," says Ajit Kumar. "Our product team now works closely with the editors to optimize the best performing content for even better visibility." As a whole, by taking action on the data insights provided by Looker Studio, Jagran saw a 300% increase in brand lovers.

Ajit Kumar adds that despite having a partner to work with on the implementation and to support

with ongoing improvements and modernization, the Google Cloud team has been consistent in providing support, with quick response times whenever needed. This positive relationship has been an invaluable asset to the organization that goes beyond product capabilities.

Releasing new applications quickly and efficiently for business growth

Jagran Media used to take about 15 days to release a new application, which included working with the vendor, completing the documentation required, and setting up the infrastructure for deployment. Now, releasing a new application can be done within a day. With the previous on-prem set up, engineers would have to provision all the hardware and software and do a load balancer configuration. However, on Google Cloud, all this is done automatically on Compute Engine, regardless of the number of environments.

"With Google Cloud, we take an application that's ready to go and just deploy it on the cloud, bypassing all the additional paperwork and infrastructure setup that is required for an on-prem deployment," says Ravi Kumar. This allows DevOps engineers to spend more time focusing on building better applications instead of doing tedious operational tasks.

With the support of Cloud Build

(<https://cloud.google.com/build>), a serverless CI/CD platform, and Cloud Run (<https://cloud.google.com/run>),

Jagran has been able to speed up application rollouts consistently, and enhance the organization's overall operational efficiency. In addition, Jagran is in the midst of building a new CMS 2.0 on a headless architecture for better content collaboration across its different properties. With Cloud Run and [Google Kubernetes Engine](https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine) (<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine>), the group will be able to release content faster, ensuring that audiences get the content they want seamlessly, at any time.

NTT's expertise and knowledge of the industry ensures that the appropriate tools and infrastructure continue to be implemented for Jagran's growth as a company. "NTT already helped provide VPC support, and laid down the best practices that worked for our business," says Ajit Kumar. "With their expertise, I believe we are in a good place as we continue to grow."

Streamlining data storage for archiving and easy access

As a media organization, Jagran needs a large amount of storage space to host a library of content for users. Whether it's for archiving or delivering content to users on demand, Jagran leverages [Cloud Storage](https://cloud.google.com/storage) (<https://cloud.google.com/storage>) to manage all of its digital assets. "With Cloud Storage, we don't have to provision or run a separate backup service like we used to when we were on-prem. Instead, we simply back up all compute and databases using persistent disk snapshots and schedule regular, automated backups with [Cloud SQL](#)

(<https://cloud.google.com/sql>)," explains Ravi Kumar. Along with the storage services, Jagran is leveraging Translation AI (<https://cloud.google.com/translate>) as it continues to add new languages to its library for users in different regions.

With all of its applications fully in the cloud, Ravi Kumar says the team is confident that their data is secure. Particularly with the implementation of Cloud Armor, that provides built-in defenses against L3 and L4 DDoS attacks. "We use Cloud Armor, and the Google Cloud Security Command Center helps us continuously monitor our entire infrastructure, with full visibility into our cloud assets." Any vulnerability is detected early so engineers can quickly mitigate a problem quickly.

Enabling a hybrid workplace for employees

Since implementing Google Workspace (https://workspace.google.com/intl/en_sg/), employees at Jagran are required to work and store all their documentation in Drive (<https://workspace.google.com/products/drive/>). This not only ensures that information is kept secure, but provides employees the flexibility to work remotely and have full access to everything they need. Teams across the organization also use Google Meet (<https://workspace.google.com/products/meet/>) regularly for meetings and catch-ups. "Meet has played a big role as work from home became a norm in the wake of Covid," says Ravi Kumar. "Online meetings, whether administrative or otherwise, became a regular part of the daily work process, and that has

continued even until today. It's not something that we'll stop using."

"Revenue optimization will be top of mind but with CMS 2.0, we will be able to create content that our audience will want to consume as we build our subscription model. This will be based on the archival data available on Google Cloud. We also look to expand our reach to gain new audiences, and we look

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—*Debosmita
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Moving forward, Jagran has big plans to continue building its brand in collaboration with Google Cloud. "Revenue optimization will be top of mind but with CMS 2.0, we will be able to create content that our audience will want to consume as we build our subscription model. This will be based on the archival data available on Google Cloud. We also look to gain new audiences by including different languages, and we look forward to an even deeper collaboration with Google Cloud as we grow our reach in Tier 3 and Tier 4 cities," says Debosmita Bhattacharya, Product Head, Jagran New Media.